CONFIDENTIAL DEPOSITION OF DANIEL CHEN

Rivera v. Northwind Appliance Co., Case No. 1:25-cv-04417 (S.D. Fla.)
Taken September 18, 2025, Miami, Florida. Excerpted pages.

Q. Please state your name and position.
A. Daniel Chen. I am the Director of Product Safety at Northwind Appliance Co. I have held that role since 2019.
Q. Are you familiar with the DW-500 dishwasher?
A. Yes. My team ran the safety testing on it.
Q. I'm handing you what has been marked Exhibit 3. Do you recognize it?
A. Yes, it's an email I sent to Linda Park, our Vice President of Operations, in August 2021.
Q. What prompted that email?
A. Our thermal test report came back on August 2, 2021. It showed the door-latch harness running more than 30 percent above the design temperature during the drying cycle.

Q. What did you recommend?
A. I recommended a redesign of the harness and that we pause shipments until the redesign was ready.
Q. Were shipments paused?
A. No. Shipments continued.
Q. Was the harness eventually redesigned?
A. Yes. The revised harness, which we called Rev. C, went into production in April 2023.
Q. Did the redesign apply to units already sold?
A. No. It applied to new production only.
Q. Did Northwind ever issue a recall of the DW-500?
A. There was no recall. There was a discussion about a voluntary recall in late 2023, but it was not approved.
Q. By December 2023, how many consumer complaints had Northwind received about DW-500 overheating?
A. I believe the number was 212 complaints by the end of December 2023.

Q. Were any of those complaints about fires?

A. Some described smoke or melting. I recall at least fourteen that described an actual fire.

Q. Who made the decision not to pause shipments in 2021?

A. That decision was made by Ms. Park's operations team.

Q. Did you agree with that decision?

MR. HOLLOWAY: Objection, form.

A. I thought we should pause. I said so at the time.

Q. Nothing further on this topic.

REPORTER'S CERTIFICATE: I certify that the foregoing is a true and accurate transcription of the testimony given by the witness. Certified September 30, 2025.